47TH ANNIVERSARY



BANDEEP SINGH

Rahul Mishra

It's not every day that you find yourself in the company of Yves Saint Laurent or Karl Lagerfeld. Rahul became the first Indian designer to join their ranks when he won the prestigious International Woolmark Prize for 2013/14. Mishra's innovations are not only in design—where he has crafted a whole new language by use of multiple embroidery techniques such as French knots, *aari*, *zardozi* and styles invented in his atelier on imaginative handloom designs. The designer has also successfully implemented reverse migration for his artisans, encouraging them to work from their villages rather than in the tough, crowded environs of the cities. The firsts don't end here, they still keep coming. In 2020, Mishra became the first Indian designer to present his work at the Paris Haute Couture Week.

Anita Dongre

When the Princess of Wales, Kate Middleton, wore a customised dress by Anita Dongre on her maiden visit to India in 2016, her website crashed. Dongre herself takes fame in her stride, focusing instead on her passion project: empowering the women of Rajasthan and Gujarat to preserve their local craft. Female artisans from Kutch dressed in traditional attire were the showstoppers in her show for the Lakme Fashion Week in Mumbai in 2015. A strong advocate of animal rights and sustainability, Dongre has also long expounded on the merits of slow fashion. Her sub-label, Grassroot, retails a fusion line that marries the crafts of India, such as Ahir embroidery from Gujarat, Ikat from Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh, Warli patterns from Maharashtra, and hand-block prints on matka silk from Bhagalpur. She is now taking her fashion and message abroad as she opens two boutiques in New York showcasing her eponymous bridal line, jewellery and accessories. *Fortune India* put her on its list of 50 Most Powerful Women in Business in 2013. A power that has only grown since.



MANDAR DEODHAR